

Terms of Reference

Delivery of Skills Training on ICT Courses under ‘Advancing Youth Employability through Skills’ project

1. Background

Swisscontact was established in 1959 as an independent foundation by notable figures from the worlds of commerce and science in Switzerland. It is exclusively involved in international development cooperation and has carried out its mandated projects since 1961. Based in Zurich, Swisscontact currently manages 133 projects in 41 countries on behalf of public and private funding partners.

Bangladesh’s rapidly expanding freelance economy—currently contributing nearly USD 1 billion and involving more than 650,000 freelancers—presents significant opportunities for youth employment. However, outdated training curricula, limited access to niche ICT skills, and persistent barriers faced by women and Persons with Disabilities (PWDs) restrict the sector’s full potential. Building on its extensive experience in skills development, Swisscontact proposes a one-year initiative designed to enhance youth employability and strengthen the country’s digital workforce.

Swisscontact Bangladesh, under the AYETS project, is seeking to engage Training Service Providers (TSPs) with demonstrated experience in delivering vocational and skills development training to **Persons with Disabilities (PWDs)**. Selected TSP will be responsible for providing specialised ICT skills training to a minimum of 25 Persons with Disabilities, contributing to the project's broader inclusion targets. The initiative aims to train **50 persons with disability (PwD)** aged 18–35 in Dhaka and Chittagong division.

2. The objective of the assignment

Each TSP will be required to enrol, train, and support a minimum of 25 Persons with Disabilities. Prospective TSPs are encouraged to outline in their proposals how they intend to identify, reach, and retain PWD trainees, including any existing networks, referral pathways, or community partnerships they will draw upon. Training will be delivered within the project's operational divisions of Dhaka and Chattogram. TSPs must confirm their operational presence and training delivery capacity within at least one of these divisions. AYETS project may decide to onboard multiple TSPs depending on the project requirement.

Scope of Services:

The selected Training Service Provider/s will be expected to:

- Design and deliver specialised ICT training programmes tailored to the specific learning needs and accessibility requirements of Persons with Disabilities, in alignment with AYETS project curricula and quality standards.

- Ensure that training facilities, materials, and delivery methodologies are fully accessible and inclusive, accommodating a range of disability types including but not limited to physical, visual, hearing, and cognitive disabilities.
- Conduct pre-training assessments to identify individual learning needs and adapt training delivery accordingly.
- Provide a supportive and enabling learning environment that promotes active participation, confidence building, and skills retention among PWD trainees.
- Coordinate closely with Swisscontact Bangladesh on participant selection, training schedules, progress monitoring, and reporting requirements.
- Maintain accurate attendance, progress, and outcome records for all PWD trainees and submit regular updates to Swisscontact Bangladesh in the agreed format and frequency.
- Support trainees in accessing freelancing platforms and remote work opportunities upon completion of training, in coordination with the AYETS project team.
- Participate in project reviews, learning events, and monitoring visits as required by Swisscontact Bangladesh.

Who Should Apply

Given the specialised nature of this engagement, Swisscontact Bangladesh recognises that the number of organisations with established experience in both PWD-inclusive training delivery and ICT skills development may be limited. In view of this, prospective TSPs are encouraged to apply even where their experience sits primarily in PWD-inclusive training rather than ICT specifically, provided they can demonstrate a credible plan for delivering the required technical content in partnership with relevant ICT practitioners or through curriculum support provided by the AYETS project team. This ToR is open to organisations that meet one or more of the following criteria:

- Organisations with established experience in delivering training or skills development programmes to Persons with Disabilities.
- Organisations working with PWD communities in support, rehabilitation, or livelihood capacities who are interested in and capable of expanding into skills training delivery.
- Organisations with ICT training experience who have existing networks, outreach capacity, or partnerships that would enable them to identify and engage and train PWD trainees.

3. Geographical Location: Dhaka and Chattogram divisions.

4. Information Required from Applicants:

Interested organisations are requested to provide the following information in their technical proposal.

Section 1: Organisation Profile

- Name of organisation.
- Year of establishment.
- Legal registration status and registration number.
- Primary area of work and target beneficiaries.
- Operational divisions or districts where the organisation is currently active.

Section 2: Experience with Persons with Disabilities

- Briefly describe your organisation's experience working with Persons with Disabilities. How long have you been working with this group and in what capacity?
- What types of disabilities does your organisation have experience working with?
- Do you have existing networks or referral pathways for identifying and reaching PWD youth? Please describe briefly.

Section 3: Training Capacity

- Has your organisation delivered skills training or vocational programmes before? If yes, please provide a brief description of the programmes, the number of beneficiaries trained, and the outcomes achieved.
- Do your training facilities accommodate Persons with Disabilities? Please describe the accessibility features available.
- Do you have experience delivering ICT related training? If yes, please describe.
- If you do not have ICT training experience, how do you propose to deliver the required technical content? Please outline your plan.

Section 4: Geographic Coverage

- In which division or divisions are you able to deliver training, Dhaka, Chattogram, or both?
- Do you have an existing operational presence in your stated division or divisions?

Section 5: Organisational Capacity

- How many full-time staff does your organisation currently employ?
- Is your organisation currently implementing other projects or programmes? If yes, please briefly describe to indicate available bandwidth for this engagement.

5. Outline of Technical Proposal

- Cover letter
- A technical proposal- The technical proposal must include a proposed detailed model and trades and work plan and reflect the understanding of the assignment and the proposed methodology of how the assignment will be carried out.
- CVs and profiles of the key personnel involved in the assignment (including trainers).
- A list of the existing sample of works and clients of the organisation.
- Training infrastructure setup in the project divisions (description and pictures)

The bidding organisations must submit documentary evidence like Registration/Trade license, TIN, BIN, and proof of submission of returns to NBR (Organizations not fulfilling this mandatory eligibility criteria will not be considered for evaluation)

6. Evaluation Process

The selection of Training Service Providers will follow a structured two-stage evaluation process based on quality and cost considerations.

Stage One: Technical Proposal Evaluation

In the first stage, all submitted proposals will be evaluated against the technical evaluation criteria outlined in this TOR. To progress to the second stage, applicants must achieve a minimum score of 50% of the total marks allocated for the technical proposal. Applicants who do not meet this threshold will not be considered further.

Stage Two: Presentation and Financial Proposal Evaluation

Applicants who successfully pass the technical evaluation threshold will be invited to present their technical proposal to the evaluation panel. Following the presentation, financial proposals will be evaluated. The proposal with the lowest budget submission will receive the highest financial score, and all other proposals will be scored proportionately based on how their proposed budget compares to the lowest bid.

Final Selection

The final selection will be made on the basis of a combined score drawn from three components: the technical proposal evaluation from Stage One, the proposal presentation, and the financial proposal evaluation from Stage Two. If required, shortlisted applicants may be invited to a budget negotiation meeting to review and revise their technical and financial proposals before a final selection decision is made. Shortlisted applicants may also be subject to an on-site assessment visit by project staff to verify organisational capacity and training facilities prior to advancing to the second stage, if deemed necessary.

7. Evaluation Criteria:

Scoring criteria		Score
	Profile of the TSP and CVs of personnel to be associated with the project	20

Profile and experience of the Training Service Provider	Years of relevant experience	10
	Sample of previous work	10
Proposed detailed model and trades and work plan		20
Presentation and Q&A		20
Financial proposal		20
Total Score		100

8. Submission Guideline

The technical proposal must be submitted both **physically and online (to the email provided below), and** financial proposal must be submitted in **hardcopy** to the following address. For hardcopy submission, it is recommended to use separate envelopes for the technical and financial proposals. Please ensure that the proposals bear the titles on envelopes and email subject line **"Technical proposal for Delivery of Skills Training on ICT Courses under Advancing Youth Employability through Skills' project"** and **"Financial proposal for Delivery of Skills Training on ICT Courses under Advancing Youth Employability through Skills' project"** The bidders are requested to provide the legal documents with the technical proposal.

The proposal should be submitted to the following address by July 07, 2026.

No proposal will be accepted after the deadline.

The envelope must be addressed:

Manager, Business Administration, BYETS

Swisscontact

SWISS FOUNDATION FOR TECHNICAL COOPERATION

House 28, Road 43, Gulshan 2, Dhaka 1212, Bangladesh

and email to **bd.byets@swisscontact.org**

****No late submission will be accepted***

****Swisscontact reserves the right to accept or reject any or all proposals without assigning any reason.***

****Swisscontact reserves the right to select more than one service provider for the assignment.***